

The good samaritan

In last month's *Digit*, I read a letter from Ashish Anand who said that he cannot afford all 12 issues of *Digit* in a year. I feel I can do something for him because he is missing out on something fantastic for six months in a year.

I would like to sponsor him to the extent of Rs. 1000, and if he pays the balance of Rs 800, he will be able to get a subscription for 28 months and save money on each issue too. Then onwards, he can keep saving and keep subscribing if he manages his saved money judiciously.

Ashish Mehta
Mumbai

Dear Ashish,

We have sent you the e-mail ID of the reader from Patna who, we are sure, would love to see that mail.

digit

Outsourcing and America

It is ironical that Americans are now scared of Outsourcing, and the country's politicians are using this to further their political agendas. Because, the question is: Can America do without Outsourcing?

The companies that outsource see value in it, because they get more efficient workers at a fraction of the cost without the additional burden of healthcare, insurance and superannuation.

In fact, it would be interesting to find out how US companies fare with regards to operating profits and their stocks, if the companies they outsource from take leave of absence for a week. We could also monitor its impact on the economy in general, and the common man, in particular.

In return, it would be interesting to let US companies take leave of absence for supply of health care services, medicines and military services to other countries, and look for a global impact.

Here is what I feel could happen:

1. Most banking, insurance, airlines and telecommunications customers would not get any phone services.
2. People would be happy to see a drop in telemarketing calls.
3. Most large organisations will not be able to execute back office processing.
4. Software companies will have to reschedule their delivery schedules, or pay



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana

5. Stocks will plummet, as companies start losing customers.

This could happen in the second case:
1. BPO companies will continue providing services to US companies' clients, managing the tough customers.

2. People in poor countries anyways have more immunity.

3. There will be fewer terrorist attacks on American allies, lowering the demand for emergency health care services.

I hope, then, the debate on outsourcing will end once and for all.

Ketan Patel,
Auckland, New Zealand

What's up with you?

The news piece on Hitachi's 400 GB Deskstar 7K400 in the April 2004 issue was surprising. Does your writer think that disk spaces are only for storing readable files? Has (s)he never heard of program files which you never read, but work for you anyway and take up large amounts of disk space? Has (s)he never heard of the enormous need of servers for disk space? Why do you think they use Raids?

A couple of decades ago, someone said that all the memory you would ever need for a computer is 640 KB. He is a much-reformed man today. His name is Bill Gates. Is another such genius hiding behind the question: "Why would you want to buy this behemoth?"

K S V Menon

Dear K S V Menon

Rest assured, we do not have a genius of the likes of Bill Gates with us. At least he is not visible to us right now.

We will be happy, however, to be proved wrong, as so many people have been in history.

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In the nick of time

Thank you for the April 2004 issue. It came just in the nick of time when I was about to buy a printer. And with so many options around, I was unable to decide. Luckily, I read *Digit*, and did not hesitate to buy the product that the magazine recommended.

Thumbs up for your good work. Keep the tempo.

Himadri Sarkar

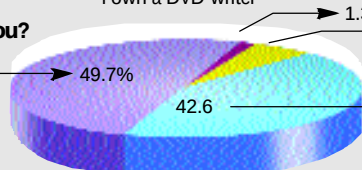
Dear Himadri,

Thank you for your kind words. They keep us motivated. Maybe we can time other products too so that the articles are published just in time for you to buy.

How DVD savvy are you?

I own a DVD-ROM

I own a DVD-writer



Responses: 7046

This month's question...

Google has announced a 1 GB free mailbox. Who among the following biggies, if they offer a free 1 GB mailbox, would you prefer the most?

- ☐ Hotmail ☐ Yahoo! ☐ GMail
☐ Rediffmail ☐ Indiatimes

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and

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